Optimus - Architecture (HLD)

Version 2.23 — Auto escalation and host/Gateway timing, 2026-10-29; local filing — not activated.

Predecessor: Optimus-Cost-Agent-Architecture-v2.22.pdf; SHA-256 139fc9d25f659f7fbda14c3a1e28c78757dcca288458373b9c3675ecd77f124b. Retain the predecessor unchanged in `docs/archive/`.

Native carried page bodies originate from Optimus-Cost-Agent-Architecture-v2.18.pdf (SHA-256 0f8725765fecc9a93045fd26630457dfe7112508df164a3ec5bcc55dbc976807). This complete successor retains the predecessor's carried bodies and source corrections except for the changes identified below. Page keys remain those of the native baseline.

What this edition changes. It describes ADR-029's single recovery escalation in interactive Auto planning: its trigger, configured target, bounds, notice, records, check-in and approved application on the moved-to model (§14.8). It also states the host/Gateway timing boundary: a 60-second upstream attempt, a 120-second upstream-dispatch budget and a 135-second default host wait, with the processing and cancellation limitations (§14.9). These additions describe main `5977155c2bce9728156ee5898ff9e17d0ae08750`, PR #437 merged 2026-10-29T16:12:49Z, with parents `2b183c8baeb881c26121341f5825e7c212a6e5fa` and PR head `0d68dfebee35ad61fcc8f87c61838185131e8e34`.

Inspected production facts at 5977155. Interactive Auto planning can move once to the trusted registry's escalation role's first routable model after a recovery nudge has not helped. A target already current, unavailable or smaller in usable input supplies no step. A grant changes the active model, route and target limits while preserving captured history, authority and incurred receipts; the turn's approved application uses the moved-to model. Fixed-model and headless callers gain no escalation. Gateway dispatch checks and worker deadlines bound upstream waits, with at most 32 outstanding attempt workers. The dispatch budget is not an end-to-end deadline on the Gateway's own processing.

Provenance and controlling Plan 12.2 amendment. Unchanged baseline statements retain `91fd64ac78025efe1076bddb106ff89e6adb2030` provenance; localized EDIT and its execution-path corrections retain `57e2069414fef32c6a6e4de42bd0dc7fb9f4f1ac`; the predecessor's original registry, production-construction and Auto statements retain `bf440cba5c184f8bca7ed8af0a0ae6bb824f14f1`. This is not a full current-state refresh. The 2026-10-18 amendment, `docs/sources/plan-12-2-ordinary-shipping/architecture-amendment.md`, remains controlling for unrefreshed Plan 12.2 material, including source/compaction policy, profiles, maintenance and historical evidence. Guardrails is unchanged. ADR-024 governs interactive detection, one nudge and the Continue/Stop check-in; ADR-029 extends that recovery with one Auto escalation. Retained interim limits and legacy goal-loop descriptions do not override those decisions.

Evidence stays attached to its source. Section 15 distinguishes source inspection, unit composition, reported Windows suites, Linux PR CI at test merge ref `a53b6888`, scripted acpx/Zed escalation and real-model Zed cases. A real model stuck enough to escalate remains owed in #397; scripted evidence stands in. Z2's lost billed reply and its absence of a rerun remain disclosed. No historical receipt is promoted to a run on `5977155`.

Authority. Codex's architecture wording; local filing by Claude under the operator's 2026-10-29 answer, verbatim, "Yes, all four", to Claude's post-merge-follow-up question, whose fourth item commissioned this successor with Codex writing and Claude checking/building. Publication to main requires the operator's separate approval. `SKIP=check-added-large-files` has not been approved for these PDFs. The filing label describes this document, not whether the pinned product feature is enabled. This document grants no additional implementation, service-change, paid-call, hook-bypass or publication authority. No product suite or live call was run to author this text.

1. Executive Summary

Conceptual framing adapted from evolutionary software boundaries formulated by Neal Ford, Rebecca Parsons, and Patrick Kua (O'Reilly, 2026). The Optimus-Cost-Agent transitions from a basic token-routing utility to a formal Harness Engineering framework designed to govern non-deterministic generation via deterministic software boundaries. Standard AI agents are fundamentally bounded by the Dreyfus model's skill acquisition ceiling; they cannot brute-force their way past the competent or proficient barrier into true architectural consistency through raw scaling alone. Optimus raises the agent's effective architectural competence through deterministic constraints and feedback by wrapping logical model abstraction inside an opinionated local-first Python ACP server governed by automated, multi-tier architectural fitness functions and explicit request-level cost attribution.

2. Harness Engineering & Context Optimization

To protect the token window from context bloat while systematically mitigating hallucination, the agent structure enforces a strict division between Feedforward Controls and Feedback Sensors:

- **Feedforward Controls (Pre-Generation):** Before a prompt payload hits the downstream model, the Context Optimization Node constructs structural boundaries. The intended controls are AST-based functional slices, static filesystem metadata placed at the head of the prompt window to maximise verified route input caching, and succinct constraints injected in an Architecture Definition Language (ADL) dialect. At the inspected source (91fd64a) the implemented controls are bounded workspace evidence assembly, the Redis structural state store and the optional Context Engine view (§14); an AST slicing component and an ADL constraint injector are specified but not established by inspection (no `ast` import and no ADL grammar under `src/`). See §15.
- **Feedback Sensors (Post-Generation Evaluation):** Once the primary model provider emits a candidate patch, the engine catches the text stream inside a validation loop. It intercepts execution blocks and evaluates them via automated, triggered fitness functions before any source mutations are applied to the active working tree. The implemented gate is the composite fitness runner in `optimus.gates` (`FitnessGateRunner` over composition-supplied `FitnessCheck` callables, run against the shadow workspace by `ShadowWorkspaceMutationRunner`); the set of checks is supplied by the composition, not fixed by this document. This describes compositions using that runner. On the ACP Agent-mode WRITE/EDIT path, no shadow execution or fitness check precedes the write (§7); an EDIT applicability failure stops the run rather than entering fitness-driven replanning.

3. Automated Architectural Fitness Functions

Optimus treats system governance not as a passive logging layer, but as an active, objective integrity check on core architectural traits. Phase 1 specifies highly targeted, local validation primitives organised across five operational planes: Scope (Atomic), Automation (Automated), Invocation (Triggered), Return (Static), and Activation (Proactive). These gates intercept code generations mid-flight to fix structural deviations before changes lock into local Git trees. Implementation status: the composite fitness gate runner and shadow-workspace promotion exist and are unit/integration tested; the named architecture-metric checks (PyTestArch, maintainability index/complexity) are intended checks with no dependency, import or test at 91fd64a (§15).

4. Data Governance Plane & Local Storage Boundaries

To support enterprise compliance review, data within the local container is sharply bounded. Unparsed source code is strictly prohibited from entering persistent vector indexes. This is a storage-boundary rule for persistent indexes; it does not by itself establish that no source text is disclosed through prompts, logs, conversation history, telemetry metadata or backups, and generated summaries can also carry sensitive content (§14.3). The storage engine uses standard Redis HASH structures to catalogue structural class signatures, summaries, and relative file paths. Numeric performance histories are channelled separately to RedisTimeSeries (tracking tokens_input, tokens_output, cost_usd) tagged by unique run_id strings with a 30-day retention (2,592,000,000 ms, `TS.CREATE` with `TS.ALTER` fallback in `optimus.telemetry.redis_adapter`).

5. Request-Level Cost Attribution

Target contract after the named trusted-policy / Task 11 / coverage migration as applicable; the dated inactive production baseline is stated on the cover.

5A. Upstream Aggregator Cost Normalization and Single-Key Model

`OPTIMUS_API_KEY` is the only agent-facing credential. It is a local shared secret used to authenticate the agent process to the loopback Optimus Gateway; it is not an upstream vendor key or an Optimus tenant wallet. The Gateway process holds one developer-owned aggregator credential: `OPTIMUS_LOCAL_GATEWAY_PROVIDER_API_KEY`, a Gateway-child-only secret that the launch policy resolves from `.env.gateway`, the OS keyring or the ambient environment with recorded provenance and never projects to the agent child. OpenRouter is the default aggregator. Vercel AI Gateway is an allowed second OpenAI-compatible endpoint by design; no Vercel integration exists at the inspected source (91fd64a).

The developer funds the aggregator account directly. The aggregator supplies access to many models, routes across upstream providers, reports normalized usage and USD cost, and debits one developer-owned balance. The local Gateway preserves the one-key, one-account, one-ledger model by isolating that credential from the LLM-driven agent, enforcing trusted policy and capacity controls; host finite-work bounds remain separate, and recording provider-reported usage.

There is no Optimus-hosted account, prepaid balance, subscription, tenant, org, project wallet, OAuth/device flow, or public Optimus Gateway.

Normalized cost path

Stage	Credential and responsibility
Local agent	`OPTIMUS_GATEWAY_URL` and `OPTIMUS_API_KEY` only
Loopback Gateway	Shared-secret auth, policy, capacity, attribution, aggregator credential isolation
Aggregator	Models, routing, provider-reported billing units and `cost_usd`
Local ledger	Run/session/request/Gateway/provider request attribution

Web search: at the inspected source the Gateway's search provider is Tavily, configured with `TAVILY_API_KEY` in the Gateway process only (`optimus_gateway.providers.build_tool_dependencies`, `TavilyWebToolProvider`); a second, Gateway-held key and balance therefore exist for search today. The accepted target is a dedicated, deterministic OpenRouter plugin request sharing the aggregator credential. That target was measured once by the 2026-07-27 architecture spike (`tools/run_openrouter_web_search_spike.py`, run against OpenRouter directly) and is not implemented in the Gateway. The one-key property holds for model completions today; for search it is a target, not a current fact. Package registry and OSV calls are free public APIs and are not funding paths. OpenTelemetry trace export has no invented per-request charge.

The one-key property for search is explicitly conditional: OpenRouter has deprecated its deterministic plugin, and no deterministic aggregator successor is presently documented. Plugin withdrawal may require a verified-or-fail server-tool design or a standalone search provider with a second key and balance.

Target contract after the named trusted-policy / Task 11 / coverage migration as applicable; the dated inactive production baseline is stated on the cover.

6. Deterministic Data-Flow Architecture (Phase 1 MVP)

The updated system design integrates closed-loop Harness Engineering directly into the orchestration sequence:

1. User Request Initiated (IntelliJ IDEA Client).
2. Ingress over ACP Protocol over StdIn JSON-RPC to the Optimus ACP Server Daemon (Asyncio Pipeline).
3. Read Topology & Structural Memory Maps from Local Redis State Store (HASH Schema Core Pull), which returns active code signatures and cached map assets.
4. Processing inside the Context Optimization Node [FEEDFORWARD CONTROLS]: intended AST Slicing, Polyglot Fallbacks, ADL Constraint Prompt Injection, and Prompt Anchoring for Cache Tuning. At 91fd64a this step is bounded workspace evidence assembly plus the optional Context Engine view (§14); the AST and ADL components are not established by inspection.
5. Emits the bounded context payload to an eligible planning/answer model under the enforced curated registry. Ordinary launches use their configured fixed model. With `OPTIMUS_AGENT_MODEL=auto`, the approved Auto composition classifies the turn and selects its model before planning or answering; that model remains bound except for ADR-029's single recovery escalation in interactive Auto planning (§14.8). The moved-to model also serves that turn's approved application. Fixed-model and headless launches do not gain escalation.
6. **Delivery to the loopback Optimus Gateway -> approved upstream aggregator (OpenRouter by default; Vercel AI Gateway if retained), returning the model output and provider-reported usage and USD cost. Model aliases remain policy inputs, but the agent never selects or contacts a direct provider adapter.**
7. Validation inside the Automated Fitness Function Engine [FEEDBACK SENSORS]: the composite fitness gate (`optimus.gates`) runs the composition-supplied checks against the shadow workspace. PyTestArch and maintainability-index/complexity checks are intended check implementations; none is a dependency, import or test at 91fd64a. On FAIL: loops back to Step [6] while the finite planning bounds permit; on PASS: approves the code patch execution path. On the ACP Agent-mode WRITE/EDIT path, no shadow execution or fitness check precedes the write (§7); an EDIT applicability failure stops the run rather than entering fitness-driven replanning.
8. Storage inside the Local Storage Engine Persistence Layer via Async TS.ADD Numeric Telemetry Tracking (RedisTimeSeries) and Async HSET Workspace Metrics Serialisation (Redis HASH Architecture Indexes).
9. Cost and usage updates delivered to the ACP client as usage notifications; a dedicated IDE FinOps dashboard panel is a client-side intent, not an Optimus component.

7. Agent Operating Modes & Trust Framework

To guarantee user trust and operational predictability, the control plane implements strict execution state isolation:

- **Plan/Chat Mode:** Advisory-only mode. The agent may inspect context, discuss requirements, propose plans, and produce diffs or snippets for review, but it must not mutate the repository, filesystem, external services, or user/project state. Internal cost, audit, and performance telemetry is append-only and explicitly allowed.
- **Agent Mode:** Execution mode. The agent is write-authorised and empowered to actively modify code, run tools, create files, update tests, and apply patches within approved workspace boundaries. At `57e2069`, the ACP WRITE/EDIT path requires exact approval of the plan text and hash, then `assert_mutation_allowed` / `MutationGuard` and `PreToolGuard`, before a direct working-tree write. Plan TESTs run afterwards in the working tree. Shadow execution and pre-write fitness checks apply only to compositions using `ShadowWorkspaceMutationRunner`; no ACP production path uses it at this pin. An EDIT applicability failure stops the run rather than entering fitness-driven replanning. This is not a host-wide guarantee over external processes.
- **Code Generation Scope Classification:** Delineates advisory inline fragments from implementation deliverables based on clear architectural criteria:
  - `INLINE_SNIPPET`: Explanatory text fragments under 15 lines that touch zero core packages and create/delete no files.
  - `PATCH_PROPOSAL`: A bounded diff or file mutation proposal for review.

- `IMPLEMENTATION_DELIVERABLE`: A multi-file change that requires Agent Mode and all release gates.

The enumeration continues on the next page with the four-value classification the permission layer uses (`MULTI_FILE_CHANGESET` is the implemented impact class in `optimus.guardrails.permissions`); a `CodeGenerationScope` enum is not present as such at 91fd64a.

At `57e2069`, a plan declares at most one WRITE/EDIT target. Multi-target mutation directives cannot be expressed (#408). This does not confine the effects of TEST subprocesses. The guarded write declares `FILE_MUTATION` for WRITE and EDIT alike; EDIT is not assigned `PATCH_PROPOSAL` (`src/optimus/agent/directives.py`, `src/optimus/tools/mutation_tools.py`).

– **PATCH_PROPOSAL:** Token streams over 15 lines that edit existing code assets exclusively without file structural modifications.

– **FILE_MUTATION:** Single-file generation operations, re-writes, or file deletions that require shell checking or tool alignment.

– **MULTI_FILE_CHANGESET:** High-risk operations touching shared/core architecture modules, crossing distinct directory roots, or altering multi-package configuration environments.

8. Tool Governance & Evidence Acquisition

Optimus treats tool use as policy-driven first, model-requested second: the model may ask for evidence, but the harness alone decides whether a tool is allowed, necessary, and cost-justified. This keeps tool invocation aligned with the same cost-control discipline applied to model routing.

Tool Stack (Phase 1)

Tool Class	Examples	Invocation Style
Local repo discovery	rg, file reader, AST parser, dependency graph, git diff	Deterministic, cheap, first-line
Validation gates	Tests, lint, type check, architecture fitness checks, security scan subset	Deterministic after patch generation
Patch workspace	Shadow apply, diff parser, rollback, working-tree apply	Agent mode only
Cost telemetry	RedisTimeSeries, run metadata hash, pricing snapshot	Always-on internal telemetry
Web evidence	Gateway search + extract (Tavily-backed)	Policy-triggered, read-only
Package/version metadata	PyPI, npm, Maven Central, GitHub releases, OSV.dev	Only when dependency/version/security task requires it
External execution	Shell, build, test, package install	Agent mode only, gated

Deterministic Invocation Policy

A ToolInvocationPolicy matrix maps task signals to permitted tool classes, so "search the web" is never a casual model impulse. Representative triggers:

- User explicitly asks for current/latest/external facts → web search.
- Task mentions library/API/framework behaviour not present in the repo → official-doc web search.
- Task touches dependencies → package registry lookup.
- Task touches security/CVEs → OSV or advisory lookup.
- Task asks for a local code change → local repo search first, no web by default.
- Model makes an architectural claim without inspected evidence → file inspection or Assumption Ledger entry.
- Patch generated → shadow apply + fitness gates.

- Fitness gate fails -> reflection or targeted local inspection.
- Plan/Chat mode active -> read/search tools only, no mutation tools.

Each web-evidence request carries an explicit reason code (e.g. API_DOCS_OUTDATED, CURRENT_FACT, SECURITY_ADVISORY, USER_REQUESTED, PACKAGE_VERSION) plus an allowed-domain list, result cap, and search-depth setting, so external calls remain auditable and cost-bounded rather than ad hoc.

Web evidence acquisition is wrapped behind Optimus-owned typed tools rather than exposing a third-party search API directly to the model. This lets the harness enforce allowed domains, timeouts, retries, result caps, and cost telemetry uniformly. Key rule: local evidence first, external evidence only when policy-triggered, mutation only after mode gates and, where composed, fitness gates pass. On the ACP Agent-mode WRITE/EDIT path, mutation follows mode, exact approval and guard checks; no fitness gate runs before the write (§7).

The preceding page's "Patch workspace" row ("Shadow apply, diff parser, rollback, working-tree apply") and "Patch generated -> shadow apply + fitness gates" trigger do not describe the ACP WRITE/EDIT path at `57e2069`. EDIT is not a diff. Exact OLD/NEW blocks are parsed by `src/optimus/agent/directives.py`, applied by `src/optimus/agent/edits.py` and written through the guarded write in `src/optimus/tools/mutation_tools.py`. This path uses no diff parser, shadow apply or rollback. Plan TESTs run after the direct working-tree write.

9. Adaptive Agent Execution Strategy & Rigor Policy

Designed strategy policy: Optimus applies adaptive execution strategies to balance cost, rigor, and reliability. The agent selects Direct Execution, Plan-and-Execute, ReAct, or Reflection based on task ambiguity, mutation risk, and validation outcomes. Reflection and deep planning are not default behaviours; they are exception-triggered circuit breakers invoked only when risk signals, failed validation, or insufficient evidence require additional rigor.

Low-Cost Hallucination Controls

- Evidence-Bound Decisions: No architectural claim may be promoted to an implementation

decision unless backed by inspected context or recorded as an explicit entry in a machine-readable Assumption Ledger.

- Rigor Budget Matrix: Bounded request tiers (LOW, MEDIUM, HIGH) prevent the agent from

spending tokens on ceremonial planning loops for simple edits:

– LOW: Cap at 5 tool calls, 0 reflection passes, min(262144, verified route window)-token total request ceiling including output; eligible fixed model.

– MEDIUM: Cap at 10 tool calls, 1 reflection pass, min(262144, verified route window)-token total request ceiling including output; eligible fixed model.

– HIGH: Cap at 15 tool calls, 3 reflection passes, min(262144, verified route window)-token total request ceiling including output; eligible fixed model.

- Trigger-Based Reflection: Reflection initialises only when validation loops trip a failure

signature or code touches shared/core architecture modules, preventing quiet token-doubling on every nominal request.

- Assumption Ledger: Bypasses token-heavy text summaries by generating an explicit JSON

ledger identifying unverified assumptions, confidence thresholds, and specific validation files needed to clear uncertainty.

- The Escalation Ladder: Bounds agent tool invocation paths to escalate strictly through a

cost-minimising chain: Provided Context -> File Inspection -> Plan -> Execute -> Validate -> Targeted Reflection -> User Escalation.

Implementation status (91fd64a): the strategy names, the LOW/MEDIUM/HIGH rigor tiers with their tool-call and reflection caps, and the Assumption Ledger are design policy. No `RigorLevel`, `ExecutionStrategy` or `AssumptionLedger` type exists under `src/`; telemetry carries `rigor_level` and `generation_scope` as string fields. The active runtime bounds are the ACP planning limits (3 planning turns by default, `OPTIMUS_MAX_PLANNING_TURNS`; 30-minute wall clock; repeated-failure limit 2 for ACP planning), the Gateway per-tool call cap (5 calls per tool per run by default, `OPTIMUS_GATEWAY_TOOL_MAX_CALLS_PER_TOOL`) and the finite loop controls referenced in §13. The min(262144, admitted

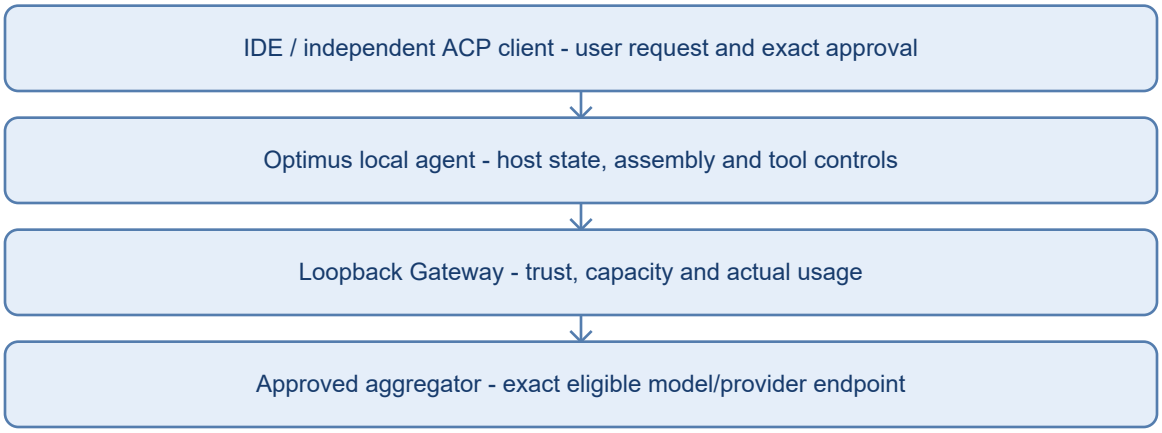
route window) planning/answer request ceiling is enforced at `bf440cb` (§14.4). Route admission includes the explicitly approved empirical-estimator exceptions; it does not make their estimates proven bounds. The preceding runtime-limit description retains its `91fd64a` pin; ADR-024 governs interactive detection, one nudge and the Continue/Stop check-in; ADR-029 adds one escalation in interactive Auto planning (§14.8).

10. Architectural Control Flow

This section provides visual reference diagrams for the two primary control flow concerns in Optimus: where the system boundaries sit, how the governance loop operates end-to-end.

10.A System context diagram

The IDE, local agent, loopback Gateway, Redis, repository and optional Phoenix collector belong to one developer environment. Agent and Gateway are separate processes; the agent receives only Gateway URL/shared secret and cannot read the Gateway aggregator credential.



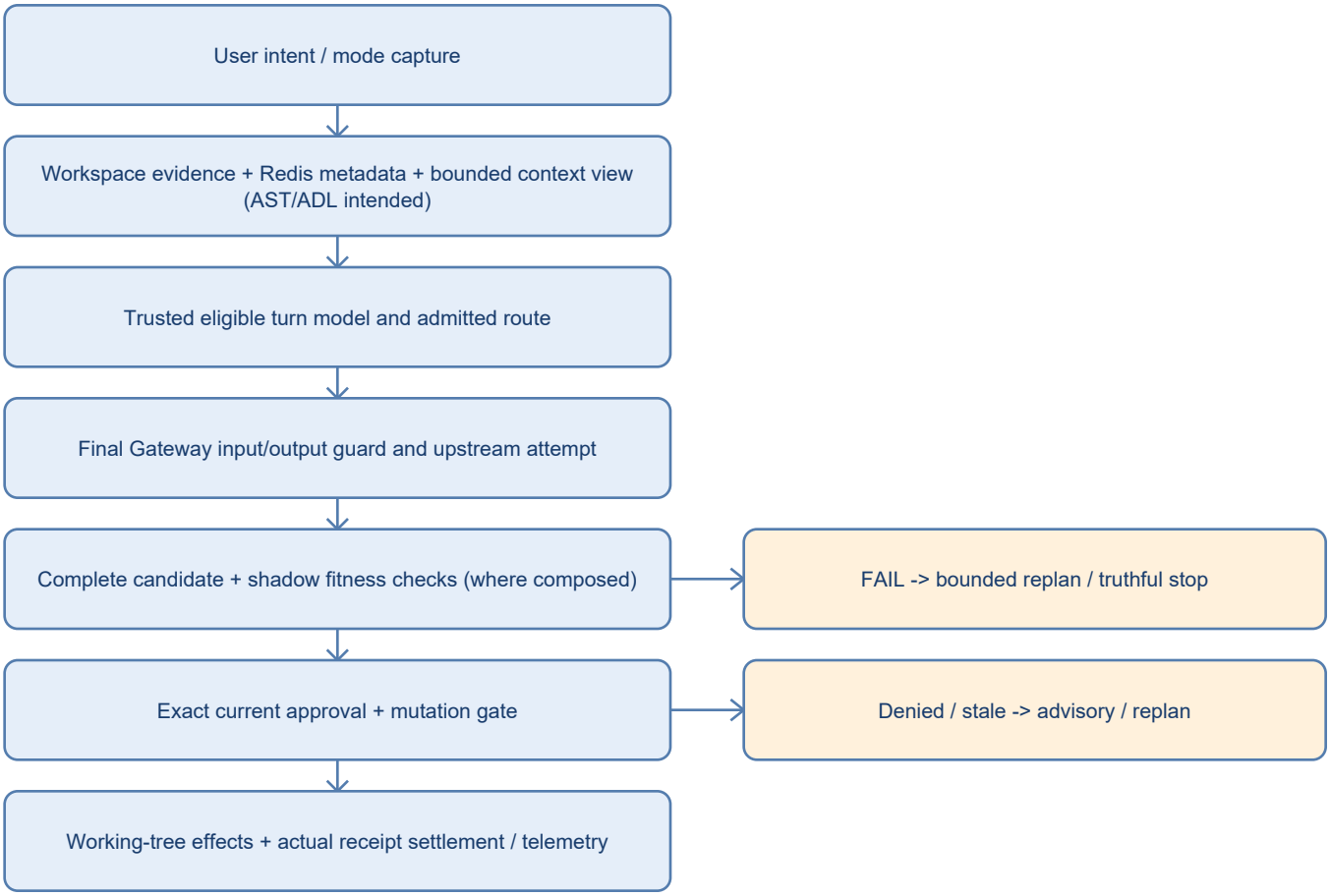
Side edge	Boundary
Agent -> repository	Current eligible workspace evidence and controlled approved edits
Agent / Gateway -> Redis	Existing state and usage ledger; no new context-engine store
Gateway -> Phoenix	Configured OTLP export; no invented billable charge
Gateway -> PyPI/npm/Maven	Independent public package APIs
Gateway -> OSV	Independent advisory service
Gateway -> OpenRouter	Default approved aggregator/model; the separately authorized search path is a target (see Tavily)
Gateway -> Tavily	Implemented web-search provider at 91fd64a with its own Gateway-only key; replacement by the aggregator plugin path is pending (§5A)
Gateway -> Vercel	Design option; no integration at the inspected source

No MCP endpoint is shown or implied. Client-supplied MCP trust/execution remains local. WSL2 agent and Windows-host Gateway do not share loopback; Phase 1 requires the same network namespace. Figure 10.A preserves that boundary and retires the product-budget label. Separate processes on one loopback network namespace isolate the aggregator credential from the agent process; they do not by themselves confine either process from the rest of the host, and whole-host confinement is not claimed.

Target contract after the named trusted-policy / Task 11 / coverage migration as applicable; the dated inactive production baseline is stated on the cover.

10.B Governance loop diagram

Every generated executable candidate remains subject to feedforward context/trust constraints and feedback/approval gates. Model selection uses the enforced registry: a configured fixed model in ordinary launches, or Auto's per-turn selection in an explicitly approved Auto launch (§14.7). The diagram abstracts that selection; it does not specify H's classifier or grant execution authority.



On the ACP Agent-mode WRITE/EDIT path, no shadow execution or fitness check precedes the write (§7); plan TESTs run afterwards in the working tree. An EDIT applicability failure stops the run rather than entering fitness-driven replanning.

A failed fitness gate supplies targeted failure context only where that gate and bounded replanning are composed; otherwise report the stop truthfully. Plan/Chat never enters the mutation path. The predecessor's three-round/30-minute/two-repeated-failure statement described its interim baseline; ADR-024 governs interactive detection, one nudge and the Continue/Stop check-in; ADR-029 extends that recovery with one Auto escalation (§14.8). Other Plan 12.3 details remain outside this scoped refresh. At `bf440cb`, Auto classification is implemented and opt-in. Product dollar stops remain removed. Auto's confidence and availability route-ups remain pre-dispatch selection. At `5977155`, ADR-029's distinct struggle-escalation rung is implemented: an interactive Auto turn may move once after its recovery nudge, before the Continue/Stop check-in. The Gateway timing boundary is specified in §14.9. Figure 10.B retains the feedforward/feedback distinction and approval/effect boundary.

Target contract after the named trusted-policy / Task 11 / coverage migration as applicable; the dated inactive production baseline is stated on the cover.

10.C Phase Evolution Diagram

Optimus is designed as a three-phase architecture. Phase 1 is mandatory before any later phase.

PHASE 1 -> Python Local Agent + Optimus Gateway Current - Mandatory before Phase 2

Release Gate: the agent runs with only `OPTIMUS_GATEWAY_URL` and `OPTIMUS_API_KEY`; no upstream key is resolvable in the agent process. The separate loopback Gateway receives only its approved aggregator key and optional infrastructure configuration.

PHASE 2 -> Rust Core Rewrite (proposed; no Rust source exists in the repository at 91fd64a) Trigger: Python performance ceiling or team scaling

PHASE 3 -> Agentic Mesh Topology (proposed) Trigger: Multi-repo / multi-team deployment

See: Optimus-Architecture-Roadmap-v11.pdf, which classifies each phase as implemented, approved requirement or proposed.

10.D Where Cost Control Happens

Cost control is not a single checkpoint - it is enforced at four distinct points in the request lifecycle, each with a different mechanism.

Control Point	Mechanism	What It Prevents
1. Pre-prompt (Feedforward)	Bounded workspace evidence and context view today; AST slicing and ADL constraints intended, not established	Unnecessary tokens sent to expensive models.
2. Router (Triage Gate)	Enforced trusted registry; configured fixed model ordinarily, or H classification and cheapest eligible unstopped model in an approved opt-in Auto launch (§14.7)	Ineligible dispatch; Auto aims to reduce unnecessary routing cost, with the measured limitations in ADR-028.
3. Rigor Budget (Runtime)	Finite work bounds: planning turns, wall clock, repeated failures and the per-tool call cap (rigor tiers are design policy, §9)	Token-doubling on ceremonial planning loops.
4. Post-call (Attribution)	Gateway usage object -> EvidenceLedger -> RedisTimeSeries	Silent cost accumulation; enables per-run audit.

10.E Where Hallucination Control Happens

Hallucination is controlled through a defence-in-depth stack. No single gate is sufficient; all five layers are intended to be active simultaneously. §15 states which layers are implemented at 91fd64a.

Layer	Mechanism	What It Catches
1. Context Constraint	Bounded workspace evidence and context view (ADL rules and AST slices intended, not established)	Irrelevant context that confuses the model.
2. Evidence Gate	Evidence-bound decisions as a design rule; no Assumption Ledger artifact at the inspected source	Unverified claims promoted to implementation decisions.
3. Tool Policy	ToolInvocationPolicy blocks casual web calls; reason codes required	Model hallucinating external facts without evidence.
4. Fitness Functions	Composite fitness gate (`optimus.gates`); PyTestArch and static-metric checks intended, not integrated; no shadow execution or fitness check precedes an ACP Agent-mode WRITE/EDIT write (§7). EDIT applicability failure stops the run without fitness-driven replanning	Structurally invalid or low-quality changes.
5. Reflection Circuit	Bounded replanning with failure context within finite work limits (reflection passes are design policy)	Repeated failure without targeted replanning.

11. Optimus Gateway - Phase 1 Local Process Boundary

The Optimus Gateway is a deterministic loopback process run by the developer alongside the local agent. It is not a hosted Optimus service, tenant control plane, subscription product, or central wallet.

Gateway responsibilities

- Bind to strict loopback and authenticate the agent with a local shared secret.
- Isolate the developer's aggregator credential in the Gateway process: the launch policy resolves it from `.env.gateway`, the OS keyring or the ambient environment with recorded provenance and projects it only to the Gateway child.
- Route explicitly eligible model IDs under the enforced trusted registry at `bf440cb` (`ENFORCEMENT_ACTIVE = True`). Planning/answer requests use the OpenAI-compatible transport; classifier decisions use the separate authenticated `/v1/decisions` route (§14.7).
- Enforce trusted model/tool policy, domain rules, request call caps, provenance and complete request capacity when enabled. Host count/time/failure limits remain separate; product dollars are accounting/alerts after the released migration.
- Return provider-reported usage and cost in a validated GatewayUsage envelope.
- Broker web search (Tavily provider at 91fd64a; the deterministic aggregator plugin is the target), bounded extract, package lookup, and OSV advisory. Independence of the package/OSV routes from search configuration is a requirement not yet met: one `GatewayToolDependencies` bundle is built, and it is `None` when `TAVILY_API_KEY`, the tool Redis URL or the allowed-domain list is missing (LLD §9C.4).
- Accept structured trace ingress, map it to OpenTelemetry, and export OTLP.
- Persist usage attribution across run, session, request, Gateway request, and provider request IDs.

Process-scoped configuration

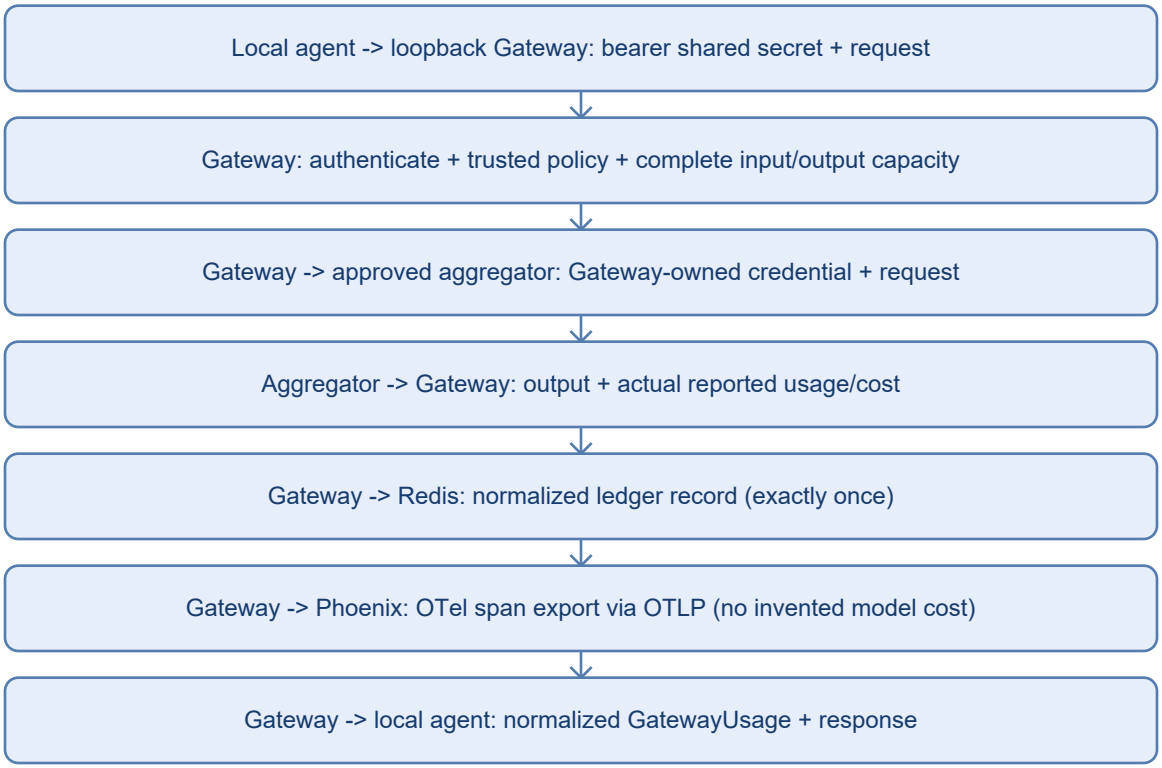
Agent process environment	Gateway process local configuration
`OPTIMUS_GATEWAY_URL=http://127.0.0.1:8765`	`OPTIMUS_LOCAL_GATEWAY_PROVIDER=openrouter`
`OPTIMUS_API_KEY=`	`OPTIMUS_LOCAL_GATEWAY_PROVIDER_API_KEY=`
	`TAVILY_API_KEY=` (Gateway-only; current search provider)
No provider, search, or OTel credentials	`OPTIMUS_LOCAL_GATEWAY_SHARED_SECRET=`
Loopback URL only	allowed domains, Redis URL, optional OTLP endpoint
No hosted-origin override	no tenant profile, Vault, or non-loopback mode

Run the agent and Gateway in the same network namespace. A Windows-host Gateway is not loopback from an agent running inside WSL2.

Target contract after the named trusted-policy / Task 11 / coverage migration as applicable; the dated inactive production baseline is stated on the cover.

11.1 Gateway request / response sequence

The actual request path retains the four actors: local agent, loopback Gateway, approved aggregator and Redis/Phoenix. The accepted product migration replaces the old monetary budget precheck with trust, complete capacity and finite work controls.



Sequence boundary	Preserved behavior
Agent to Gateway	One authenticated request over the strict loopback boundary. The aggregator credential never enters the agent process or response.
Gateway to aggregator	Only the configured approved aggregator with Gateway-owned credential. Final complete-request and output enforcement applies to every actual attempt.
Aggregator result	Parse output/true finish status and actual reported usage/cost. Unknown cost is explicit, never manufactured as zero.
Ledger and trace	Persist normalized receipt exactly once and export sanitized OTel spans independently; trace export is not a billed inference request.
Search	A separate authorized tool request (Tavily provider at 91fd64a; the aggregator-plugin annotation path is the target). Package and OSV routes are required not to depend on search configuration; at 91fd64a they are constructed in the same dependency bundle and are unavailable when `TAVILY_API_KEY` is missing (LLD §9C.4).

Independent evaluation dollar caps remain scoped to their authorized evaluations. Product dollar stops were removed at cf9bb9d and merged to `main` via PR #276 (`c509fc8`, 2026-10-08). Production registry enforcement is active at `bf440cb`; the predecessor's inactive-enforcement statement remains historical at `91fd64a`. Auto classification has its own typed Gateway route and usage receipt (§14.7); it adds no product dollar stop.

11A. OpenTelemetry trace observability

Phase 1 uses OpenTelemetry spans and OTLP as the vendor-neutral trace contract across planning, Gateway calls, tool invocation, validation, retries and final response generation. The local agent sends authenticated structured trace ingress to the Gateway; it validates/redacts fields, maps them to OTel spans/events and exports OTLP. Arize Phoenix is the documented local default. Any OTLP-compatible backend may replace it without changing Optimus instrumentation; Langfuse may be considered for team-scale deployments.

Trace export records operational telemetry, not an invented billable provider request. No allocated/amortized observability cost_usd is added to the usage ledger. Infrastructure cost is an operator concern outside per-request accounting.

Required attributes retain run, session, request, Gateway/provider request, execution mode, generation scope, model/provider, cache, cost_usd, billing units, policy/tool, validation, retry and failure attribution. Secrets are redacted before export.

12. Testing and quality gates

Concern	Tooling	Role in gates
Code coverage	coverage.py, pytest-cov	Implemented and enforced in CI at 91fd64a: `tools/check_product_coverage.py --run-full-suite` with `tools/product-coverage-groups.json` (Optimus group, context_engine and optimus_model_policy at 80%; Evidence Handoff and the aggregate informational) followed by `tools.testing.coverage_products validate`. The commit hook runs the coverage-free commit profile (`tools.testing.run_profile --profile commit`). Test Strategy v1.9 §8A governs. Safety-critical modules must not regress.
Agent quality	DeepEval, Ragas	Intended; no dependency, import or test at 91fd64a; UNRUN
Adversarial/red-team	PyRIT	Intended; no dependency, import or test at 91fd64a; UNRUN. The prompt-injection and MCP-trust fixtures in `tests/unit/guardrails` are offline positive controls for specific guards, not a red-team campaign
Trace observability	OpenTelemetry + OTLP; Phoenix default	Implemented (`optimus_gateway.observability`); the live Phoenix tier is the `requires_phoenix` marked tier and is UNRUN unless a collector is present

OTel/OTLP trace validation is tracked separately from production-code coverage. LangSmith is not part of the architecture or dependency set.

13. Agent Execution Safety & Guardrails

Agent execution safety is enforced through a layered guardrail model that wraps every tool call between the moment the agent decides to act and the moment the action takes effect: mode constraints (§7), a permission policy (allow/deny lists with a human-approval path), a pre-tool guard that deterministically validates shell, file, MCP, and network calls, sandboxed execution where composed (the shadow workspace; OS-level sandboxing is not claimed), post-tool audit against the Gateway cost and trace ledgers (§5A, §11, §11A), and commit/CI gates (§12). The same plane governs two execution patterns — bounded goal-driven agent loops and curated workflow skills — so that long-running or procedure-driven work inherits the identical constraints and the same Gateway trust, capacity and accounting policy. On the ACP Agent-mode WRITE/EDIT path, no shadow execution or fitness check precedes the write (§7); an EDIT applicability failure stops the run rather than entering fitness-driven replanning.

The premise is not that the agent is malicious but that it is a reward-hacky problem solver: under pressure to reach "done" it will reach for chmod 777, curl … | sh, force-push to main, or commenting out a failing assertion. Guardrails remove those shortcuts from its reach. Most of the model is deterministic and zero-token; a cheap, finitely bounded classifier routed through the Optimus Gateway is consulted only for borderline cases, never on the hot path of an already-allowed or already-denied call.

The detailed policy model, component contracts, and control-flow diagram are maintained in the companion specification Agent Execution Guardrails & Workflow Strategy v1.4 (control- plane diagram in its §1; LLD component contracts in its §10; test categories in its §11). The corresponding implementation contracts are specified in LLD §12 and the test categories in Test Strategy §14. This section is a cross-cutting reference only.

Implemented at 91fd64a with unit tests under `tests/unit/guardrails`, `tests/unit/agent`, `tests/unit/loops`, `tests/integration/loops` and `tests/unit/skills`: `PermissionPolicy`, `PreToolGuard`, `CommandSafetyValidator` (in-process; Tirith is not a dependency), `ConfigTrustScanner`, `MCPTrustRegistry`, `GoalLoopController` (`optimus/loops/controller.py`) with `LoopBudgetPolicy`, and `SkillRegistry` with `SkillTrustPolicy`. The classifier described here is a reserved architecture capability, not an active production route. Host finite work controls and Gateway capacity/policy enforcement have separate owners. Coverage policy is authoritative in Test Strategy v1.9 §8A: Optimus product group, context_engine and optimus_model_policy have separate 80% gates; all-source coverage is informational.

14. Optional Context Engine and Plan 12 migration

Edition scope. Registry admission, enforcement, production construction and Auto statements explicitly refreshed below describe `bf440cb`. Other material retains its earlier provenance and is read with the controlling 2026-10-18 Plan 12.2 ordinary shipping amendment (`docs/sources/plan-12-2-ordinary-shipping/architecture-amendment.md`). In particular, this edition does not replace the amendment's source/compaction policy, profiles, maintenance or historical evidence. ADR-024 controls interactive detection, one nudge and the Continue/Stop check-in; ADR-029 adds the single Auto escalation described in §14.8. Escalation and the host/Gateway timing contract (§14.9) are refreshed at main `5977155c2bce9728156ee5898ff9e17d0ae08750` (2026-10-29). Retained interim limits and legacy goal-loop descriptions are not current overrides; this is not a full Plan 12.3 refresh.

14.1 Product boundaries

`context_engine` is an optional, extractable in-process Python package. It receives immutable sanitized ordinary turns, exact host-issued execution/approval projections, strategy parameters, limits, revision identity and an injected maintenance callback. It owns derived views and checkpoints only. It imports no Optimus host, Gateway, security, evidence-handoff, workspace, Redis or provider implementation. Verified by import inspection at 91fd64a: `src/context_engine` imports only the standard library, so the zero-dependency property belongs to `context_engine` alone; `optimus_model_policy` additionally imports PyYAML and pydantic.

Optimus owns canonical storage, current prompt, exact authority, turn lifecycle, current workspace resolution, policy capture, model-facing assembly and notices. `optimus_model_policy` is neutral shared policy code; host and Gateway independently consume the trusted immutable snapshot. The Gateway alone performs approved upstream calls and enforces final request capacity for each actual attempt. Existing ledger/telemetry owners account for every attempt.

The local Gateway, shared-secret boundary, independent client-MCP trust controls, public tool dependencies and OTel/OTLP topology remain as specified in earlier sections. Plan 12 adds no Gateway MCP broker, provider key in CORE or generalized plugin platform.

14.2 Canonical source and selected views

Without the engine, retain full canonical history and inclusive 524,288-byte admission, its 80% storage warning, and the already accepted history-order/display exceptions. An attached engine may use the released offline 1,048,576-byte source class; production attachment still requires its own activation. Source size is distinct from provider request capacity and the context meter. A prompt-time 131,072-byte record reservation is not a cap on the eventual reply or entire turn.

Selection and packing are deterministic; only the summary text is generated. Compaction and Hybrid invoke the injected summarizer callback; Sliding never does. Compaction is the default. It retains a newest whole-turn exact tail and summarizes earlier ordinary history. Hybrid optionally retains the first complete turn as an exact anchor, uses a larger exact tail and summarizes the middle; deduplicate overlapping head/tail turns. Sliding takes the newest complete turns that fit, makes zero summary calls and does not skip an oversized newest turn to recover older ordinary history. All three retain exact protected state. Derived omission never deletes canonical history.

The proposed cheap/ultra-cheap history allowance is the smaller of 131,072 tokens and 80% of usable input, further constrained by final packing after protected state. It is a ceiling on history sent, not a threshold that delays summarization. The released offline summary cap is 8,192 tokens; compaction tail is 32,768 tokens, hybrid anchor 16,384 tokens and hybrid tail 65,536 tokens. Thus compaction's ordinary tail plus summary is at most 40,960 tokens; hybrid's head, tail and summary at most 90,112, before exact protected facts and other material. These are adopted offline test values carried by the reviewed test profiles and fixtures (for example `optimus_model_policy/test_profile_qualification.yaml` output reserves 32768/8192), not shipped production defaults; production defaults and route activation remain held.

Whole-turn summarization remains the simplest accepted design direction. If an indivisible older turn cannot fit maintenance, report the reason and the filed recovery choices; do not split it, silently switch strategies or discard ordinary text inside compaction/hybrid. Sliding can omit even all ordinary history when its newest turn does not fit. Any unavailable view at <=524288 projected source bytes may use full-history fallback when its complete final request fits, including an oversized turn or missing summarizer. Above that floor it refuses readably with OPEN disposition; the refusal is recoverable and introduces no

monetary latch or new fallback mechanism. Availability depends on the actual history, estimator and bounds. Within-turn splitting and delayed-trigger/call-frequency optimization remain deferred.

14.3 Authority, selection and continuity

Model-authored history and generated summaries are inert. A claim that a change ran, a test passed or an approval exists cannot create host authority. Preserve every committed turn's exact outcome/effect projection and host-issued approval facts, independently of ordinary history selection. Historical approval describes an earlier decision and grants no fresh execution.

Exact retained earlier plans/replies may supply ordinary file/skill selection hints. Resolve file references against the current eligible workspace and assemble current bounded content. A resolved path does not verify an old diagnosis. Generated summary text does not directly select files or skills. A reference appearing only in omitted history may be unavailable to selection; do not claim full-history retrieval after compaction.

Model changes preserve canonical conversation and the strategy-defined view. They do not trigger a paid whole-chat factual audit. Use existing targeted freshness checks for selected file data and controlled edit targets. Preserve approval/version checks; no background watcher, durable claim database, semantic pinning or repository-wide rescan is introduced. These controls do not eliminate races with unrelated external writers.

14.4 Capacity and policy

Every final model request uses `effective_total = min(262144, verified_route_window)`, `usable_input = effective_total - verified_output_reserve`, and a complete-input estimate that includes messages, templates, workspace/tool/evidence material and framing. Admit equality; count the actual enforced output cap once, including verified reasoning semantics. Recompute at the final Gateway boundary for every actual provider attempt. When a model has several permitted endpoints, the applicable smallest verified capacity governs. The estimator is the admitted route's byte-ratio profile (`ceil(r * UTF8_bytes)` with non-negative overhead), not exact tokenization. At `bf440cb`, ADR-025 permits an explicitly recorded per-model empirical admission with `verified: false`; `conservative-utf8` uses one token per UTF-8 byte of message/tool text, 16 tokens per message and 256 fixed. Those allowances are assumptions checked against each reply's reported input usage, not a proven universal token or framing bound. A pre-call refusal dispatches no upstream attempt for that rejected request and remains readable/recoverable; earlier maintenance attempts can still have receipts.

D7's proposed named exception retains inclusive 524288-byte canonical storage/admission and its warning, but does not guarantee that full history fits a provider request. Both absent-engine and attached full-history fallback still undergo the final complete-request guard; overflow gives the accepted readable OPEN refusal without answer/planning dispatch. Do not lower the source cap or exempt capacity. The release implements this disclosed exception offline; its verbatim D7 record is filed in ADR-018 from registered ADR-011 source S4 (decision 2026-10-04, filed 2026-10-07). Exact per-route tokenizers remain deferred; route-specific byte-ratio safety requires normalization/pre-tokenization/framing proof and cannot be inferred from samples. Unknown route facts remain ineligible except for the explicit per-entry admissions ADR-025 permits. An empirical admission records its evidence, assumptions and limitations; it does not relabel unverified facts as verified. A first call can exceed its estimate or incur a charge before the reply check stops later calls to that model.

At `bf440cb`, trusted registry enforcement is active: `ENFORCEMENT_ACTIVE = True`, and `trusted_snapshot()` composes the packaged defaults plus the trusted operator override when present. The ordinary default planner is the cheapest eligible medium model, otherwise the cheapest eligible easy model; the shipped ordinary composition admits Haiku 5.5 as easy and summarizer. The old alias/default and exclusion statements describe earlier pins, not this composition.

Role assignments, capabilities, endpoint facts, provenance and eligible per-token price ordering remain explicit registry data. Crossed prices require the declared blend; Contributor routes retain their disclosure. ADR-025 replaces the one-model/code-pinned admission with each entry's independent `empirical_estimate` and `provider_family` evidence. A provider-family admission checks the reported provider, not an exact variant. The fixed `model-registry.yaml` in the trusted operator config root composes over the shipped policy; the operator's launch approval binds the resulting effective hash. Host and Gateway compose independently. Test profiles do not read that override.

Exception-route reply checks retain usage, finish, estimate and router-attempt requirements. ADR-026 accepts an empty pipeline or exactly one narrowly qualifying unflagged `guardrail` stage; any other stage or disallowed fact refuses. This does not prove unchanged content or data handling. A failed exception-route check stops that model for the Gateway's remaining life, without stopping every other model.

Auto classification is implemented in the separately approved opt-in composition (§14.7). Reviewer/depth behavior and savings-report surfaces remain outside that delivery. Auto's pre-dispatch route-ups are distinct from ADR-029's single recovery escalation, implemented at `5977155` (§14.8).

14.5 Costs and execution

The normative product policy after the accepted D6/governed migration has no dollar-stop predicate, hidden summary reserve, positive-dollar constructor requirement, remaining-dollar planner prompt or infinite sentinel. It keeps actual provider-reported costs, exactly-once settlement, notices and explicitly configured alerts. Missing cost remains unknown, never zero; keep known subtotals and incomplete-accounting attribution. Do not automatically retry an uncertain attempt or freeze the session. A later intentional request still uses normal capacity, trust and authorization controls.

Finite work controls remain: current defaults of three Agent planning rounds, 30 minutes and two repeated failures, single-call Chat, bounded maintenance and explicit repacks. Goal loops retain their own finite count/time/failure controls. Independently authorized evaluation/test budgets remain real monetary ceilings. D6's requirement is preserved: there is no product dollar stop. Product dollar stops and remaining-dollar prompts were removed at cf9bb9d and merged to `main` via PR #276 (`c509fc8`, 2026-10-08). Independently capped evaluation remains capped, and such separately authorized evaluation spend caps are not product cost stops. Production registry enforcement is active at `bf440cb`. Ordinary bootstrap constructs the Context Engine attachment when its registry has an eligible summarizer; the amendment remains controlling for the unrefreshed compaction and maintenance details.

14.6 Evidence and release

Implementation checkpoints, measured coverage and exact acceptance/provenance are recorded in the companion closure records. Architecture targets do not promote historical evidence to changed code or establish current gate enforcement.

The absence of a production `ContextAttachment` constructor was verified at `91fd64a`; it is not current at `bf440cb`. Ordinary bootstrap now composes the route policy and ordinary attachment, and Auto reuses that attachment machinery with the selected planning/answer model's limits. An eligible summarizer remains a prerequisite; without one the composition is absent-engine. The 2026-10-18 amendment supplies the unrefreshed Plan 12.2 contracts and historical evidence qualifications. Test-profile evidence remains evidence for its named composition, not authority for an ordinary or Auto launch.

Auto implementation, its pilot and its live slices have distinct evidence (§15). Luna's Auto admission is empirical; it does not discharge every historical Plan 12.2 route/estimator qualification obligation. The final reviewer step, savings report and package publication retain separate ownership. ADR-029's single Auto escalation is implemented at `5977155`; its scripted escalation evidence and the real-model criterion still owed in #397 are distinguished in §15.

With enforcement active, capacity-specific text is selected only for INPUT_EXCEEDS_CAPACITY. The 80% request warning uses complete request size, while the separate storage notice preserves the source floor. A local Gateway dispatch reading is not proof of upstream delivery.

14.7 Auto mode: opt-in per-turn routing

Launch boundary. Only `OPTIMUS_AGENT_MODEL=auto` selects Auto. `--model auto` and an explicit model conflicting with that environment selection refuse. Auto composes packaged defaults, `auto_overlay.yaml`, then the trusted operator override. Approval binds both the effective registry literal and `_composition=auto`; ordinary and Auto approvals are not interchangeable, even if policy hashes coincide. A manually managed Auto Gateway is launched with `optimus-trust --workspace-root <workspace> run-gateway --auto`, under a durable approval binding that composition.

Selection. Before planning or answering, the host freezes a bounded sanitized prompt excerpt, captured mode, attachment metadata and the last committed routed tier. H applies its frozen rules; at rule confidence at least 0.8 it uses their answer, otherwise it asks the configured classifier through the Gateway. A valid answer below 0.95 moves up one tier, capped at complex. Missing/malformed confidence, abstention or classifier failure takes the failure rule, starting resolution at complex. These are routing heuristics, not calibrated safety guarantees.

The resolver selects the cheapest eligible unstopped model in the resulting task tier: easy, medium or complex. It tries another eligible model in the same role before moving upward when that role is unavailable; after exhausting tiers it tries the unstopped

default planner, otherwise refuses recoverably without an answer call. The default fallback can be an easy or medium model. The chosen planning/answer model, route and context limits remain bound except for ADR-029's one recovery move (§14.8). After a grant, subsequent planning and that turn's approved application use the moved-to model and route; applying the plan does not classify it again. Maintenance retains the separately selected summarizer role.

Shipped configuration. Without an operator override, the Auto composition admits Luna then Haiku for easy, Gemini 3.8 Flash for medium/complex/escalation, Jev 1.14 as classifier and Haiku 5.5 as summarizer. These are registry assignments, not model-specific logic or a guarantee that a model can solve a task. At `5977155`, the escalation role supplies ADR-029's rung-2 target in interactive Auto planning. These shipped assignments do not guarantee a stronger available step for every tier. The ordinary composition does not acquire the Auto overlay.

Calls and visibility. Jev uses authenticated `POST /v1/decisions` and the Gateway's System One adapter. The request has its own admission/reply checks and one upstream attempt with no resend. System One supplies no finish status or router-attempt/pipeline evidence; those absent checks remain disclosed. Every classifier attempt enters the turn's `classification` settlement stage; known costs remain charged and unknown costs remain unknown. An accounting-integrity failure refuses the turn instead of entering the routing-failure fallback. Cancellation prevents subsequent answer dispatch while retaining incurred receipts.

The host attempts one informational `Auto: <tier> -> <model>` notice before the routed planning/answer work and emits a content-free `auto_routing` event at most once per admitted turn. The record distinguishes routed, refused, cancelled and abandoned outcomes and records whether the notice was delivered. Notice and telemetry failures are contained; neither is a durable-delivery guarantee. The Auto host shares one monotonically growing model-stop set across its resolver, runners and summarizer; the Gateway independently enforces its per-model stops.

Authority and limits. ADR-028 accepts ADR-007 with H; the frozen ADR-007 is unchanged. The accepted pilot does not establish population error rates below 5%, and its previous-tier signal was barely tested (#425). Savings depend on the configured models and workload. A different judge mechanism has separate ownership (#426). ADR-029 accepts ADR-009 rung 2 as scoped in §14.8; #397 retains the evidence and documentation follow-ups. Auto grants no mutation authority and bypasses no exact-plan approval, guard, capacity or accounting control. §15 distinguishes source inspection, offline tests, pilot evidence and the three reported live slices.

14.8 One recovery escalation in interactive Auto planning

At main `5977155` (ADR-029). ADR-024 supplies the recovery episode: detection, one corrective nudge and the Continue/Stop check-in. In an interactive Auto session, a second detection, an allowance ending without a plan or refusal after the nudge, or a REFUSE settled after the nudge may grant one move before that check-in. A first refusal outside an episode remains a refusal; a plan produced after the nudge goes directly to the check-in. Reaching the planning limit without a detection does not itself trigger escalation.

The graph has one possible edge from the current implementer to the trusted registry's `escalation` role's first routable model. That role undergoes implementer eligibility checks. Later entries substitute for stopped earlier entries; they are not further rungs. No step exists if no target is routable, the current model is already the target, or the target has less usable input. The check-in reports when no stronger eligible model was available. Fixed-model launches, headless callers and `OPTIMUS_LOOP_RECOVERY=headless` retain their existing behavior.

A grant permits at most one move per episode and per turn. It gives the target Continue's allowance: three planning steps and a fresh 30 minutes by default. The episode remains open and proceeds to its check-in unless a halt or typed failure ends the run. The detector restarts for the target; later Continue episodes cannot grant another move in the same turn. Nothing runs while the user answers the check-in. Continue grants planning work or presents a waiting plan for its separate exact approval; it never approves a change.

Before switching, the host attempts a live notice identifying the move, its cause and the registry's input/output prices per million tokens, including the former prices. Delivery is recorded and does not gate the move; a halt wins. Contributor disclosure remains mandatory per request. Model identity, routing and target limits move together; captured history, strategy parameters, summarizer, maintenance/repack allowances and earlier receipts remain. The approved application uses the moved-to model. The initial `auto_routing` record stays the classifier's selection; `loop_recovery` records the escalation decision and, on a grant, `from_model`, `to_model` and `notice_delivered`. Each request keeps the route that sent it and its actual cost or explicit unknown.

The target is configuration, not a hard-coded model or a promise of task success. Escalation bypasses no approval, guard, disclosure, capacity or accounting check. Contracts and executable checks are in LLD §13.11; §15 qualifies their reported evidence.

14.9 Host/Gateway timing boundary

At `5977155`, the shared defaults are a 60-second upstream-attempt timeout, a 120-second upstream-dispatch budget per host request, and a 135-second host wait (`MAX_ROUTE_ATTEMPTS` × 60 seconds, plus 15 seconds of processing slack). This budget is time, not a product dollar stop. The Gateway starts a request-scoped deadline and checks that a complete attempt timeout still fits before every dispatch, including after a retry backoff. The two-attempt completion ceiling is a maximum, not an entitlement to a second attempt; the decisions route still makes at most one attempt without resend.

Each production upstream attempt is waited for through a worker-thread deadline. The Gateway abandons it at expiry, shuts down an available socket and refuses a late connection before request bytes leave. Uninterruptible setup may leave a worker running after the waiter returns; a 32-slot process-wide cap bounds outstanding workers, and a slot is held until its worker exits. `attempt_deadline`, `attempt_capacity` and `request_budget` distinguish the failures. The attempt's delivery classification remains separate: uncertain delivery/cost is never silently converted to zero or automatically resent under the enforced completion policy.

The 120-second budget controls upstream dispatch; it is not an end-to-end deadline on request reading, Stage C storage, logging or reply writing. Those operations have no whole-request deadline from this mechanism and can consume the host's slack. The 135-second default depends on responsive Gateway processing and storage. A shorter positive finite `--gateway-timeout-seconds` is allowed with a warning and can lose a billed reply; planning then retains its unknown-cost stop. A departed host's broken/reset reply socket produces a sanitized `reply_undeliverable` record. Prompt cancellation of an in-flight Gateway call and an end-to-end Gateway-processing deadline remain owed in #397. LLD §13.12 specifies the transport details.

15. Capability, verification and activation status (correction of 2026-10-15)

This section records, for the material capabilities this document names, three independent facts: whether the capability is implemented, how far it has been verified, and whether it is active. Carried statements and baseline rows retain the inspected source `91fd64ac78025efe1076bddb106ff89e6adb2030` (origin/main, 2026-10-15). The fields are independent: an implemented guard can be offline-verified and production-inactive; an approved roadmap requirement is not an unapproved idea, but neither is it implemented. A negative repository search supports "integration not established", not a claim that a tool has never been used anywhere. Accepted requirements and historical evidence are unchanged by this section; the correction map filed with the sources (`docs/sources/capability-evidence-correction/correction-map.md`) lists every change in that correction with its source reference.

Agent-mode localized EDIT statements and their execution-path corrections retain main `57e2069414fef32c6a6e4de42bd0dc7fb9f4f1ac` provenance (2026-10-24, including PR #413 and PR #414). Registry, production-construction and Auto statements explicitly updated here describe main `bf440cba5c184f8bca7ed8af0a0ae6bb824f14f1` (2026-10-27). Other rows retain their stated historical pins and have not been generally reverified at `bf440cb`. Escalation and host/Gateway timing statements expressly updated in this edition describe main `5977155c2bce9728156ee5898ff9e17d0ae08750` (2026-10-29); they do not re-pin the retained Auto, EDIT or baseline evidence.

The 2026-10-18 Plan 12.2 ordinary shipping amendment (`docs/sources/plan-12-2-ordinary-shipping/architecture-amendment.md`) remains controlling for unrefreshed Plan 12.2 material, including source/compaction policy, profiles, maintenance and historical evidence. The refreshed registry/construction rows below supersede their inactive descriptions only. ADR-024 governs interactive detection, one nudge and the Continue/Stop check-in; ADR-029 adds one Auto escalation (§14.8). The retained loop rows and numerical limits are historical. Implementation presence, reported verification and authorization to launch remain separate.

Verification vocabulary. *Code inspection* means the capability was found or not found in `src/`, `tests/`, `tools/`, `pyproject.toml` and `uv.lock` at the pin. *Offline-verified* means a sealed full-suite run on a clean candidate without live dependencies. *Live-verified* means real external dependencies under the named marked tier. *UNRUN* means a defined check that has not been executed. *UNKNOWN* means the fact could not be established.

Capability	Implementation	Verification	Activation
Loopback Gateway with shared-secret authentication (§5A, §11)	Implemented (`optimus_gateway.server`, `optimus/config/gateway.py`)	Unit and integration tests at the pin; sealed offline suites at cf9bb9d	Active
Aggregator credential isolation (§5A, §11)	Implemented: `OPTIMUS_LOCAL_GATEWAY_PROVIDER_API_KEY` is a Gateway-child-only secret resolved by the launch policy with provenance	Unit tests of launch policy and launch gate	Active
OpenAI-compatible upstream transport, OpenRouter default (§6, §11.1)	Implemented (`optimus_gateway/upstream_client.py`)	Unit tests; `requires_gateway` live tier exists	Active
Vercel AI Gateway second endpoint (§5A)	Specified; not established by inspection (no reference in `src/`)	None	Inactive
Web search provider (§5A, §8)	Implemented: Tavily (`TavilyWebToolProvider`, Gateway-only `TAVILY_API_KEY`)	Unit tests; live tiers when configured	Active when configured
Deterministic OpenRouter plugin search sharing the aggregator credential (§5A)	Specified target; not implemented in the Gateway	Spike-measured once, 2026-07-27, by `tools/run_openrouter_web_search_spike.py` outside the Gateway	Inactive

Capability	Implementation	Verification	Activation
Package and OSV routes independent of search configuration (§8, §11)	Specified; not implemented: one dependency bundle, `None` without the Tavily key, tool Redis URL and allowed domains	None	Not applicable
Bounded HTTPS extract with provenance (§8)	Implemented	Unit tests; live tier when configured	Active when configured
Provider-reported usage ledger and exactly-once settlement (§5A, §11.1)	Implemented (`optimus/usage`, `optimus/evidence`, `optimus/telemetry/redis_adapter.py`)	Unit tests; `requires_redis` tier; sealed offline suites	Active
OpenTelemetry/OTLP export to Phoenix (§11A)	Implemented (`optimus_gateway/observability.py`)	Unit tests; `requires_phoenix` live tier UNRUN without a collector	Active when configured
Mutation guard, shadow workspace and composite fitness gate (§2, §7)	Implemented (`optimus/gates`, `optimus/runtime`)	Unit and integration tests	Active for mediated tool paths at `91fd64a`. MutationGuard remains active on ACP WRITE/EDIT at `57e2069`; shadow execution and composite pre-write fitness checks are not composed on that path
Agent-mode localized EDIT directive (§7, §8)	Implemented at `57e2069` (`agent/directives.py`, `agent/edits.py`, `agent/models.py`, `agent/planning_loop.py`, `agent/runner.py`, `agent/tools.py`, `agent/prompts.py`, `agent/workspace_context.py`, `loops/tools.py`, `tools/line_endings.py`, `tools/mutation_tools.py`, `runtime/mutation.py`, `telemetry/events.py`, `acp/dispatcher.py`, `acp/spec.py`)	Unit and real-AgentRunner tests; Windows suites and PR CI at `92df22f`, `a970189` and `87b7b06`; post-merge CI at `57e2069`. One live acpx success at `92df22f` only; failure paths have unit/runner evidence only. See EDIT evidence below	Active in Agent mode at `57e2069`
PyTestArch and maintainability-index/complexity checks (§3, §6, §10.E)	Not established by inspection: no dependency, import or test	UNRUN	Inactive
AST slicing and ADL constraint injection (§2, §6, §10.D)	Not established by inspection: no `ast` import, no ADL grammar under `src/`	None	Inactive
Rigor tiers, execution strategies and Assumption Ledger (§9, §10.D, §10.E)	Specified; no `RigorLevel`, `ExecutionStrategy` or `AssumptionLedger` type	None	Inactive; active bounds are 3 planning turns, 30 minutes, 2 repeated failures, 5 calls per tool
Permission policy, pre-tool guard, shell validator, config scanner, MCP trust registry (§13)	Implemented (`optimus/guardrails`)	Unit tests (`tests/unit/guardrails`)	Active
Borderline permission classifier (§13)	Specified, reserved	None	Inactive
Bounded goal loops (§13)	Implemented (`optimus/loops`, `optimus/agent/planning_loop.py`)	Unit and integration tests	ACP planning bounds active; goal-loop activation from ACP not granted

Capability	Implementation	Verification	Activation
Curated workflow skills (§13)	Implemented (`optimus/skills`)	Unit tests	Active
Context Engine strategies, checkpoints and whole-turn packing (§14)	Engine implemented; production construction exists at `bf440cb` (`optimus/acp/bootstrap.py`, `context_attachment.py`)	Historical cf9bb9d suites retain their pins; Auto unit composition test exercises compaction. Other Plan 12.2 evidence remains under the amendment	Ordinary attachment when an eligible summarizer exists; Auto reuses it with per-model limits
Trusted registry snapshot and complete-request capacity guard (§14.4)	Enforced at `bf440cb`; per-entry admission and trusted operator override (ADR-025), narrow guardrail-stage exception (ADR-026)	Code inspection; registry/override tests; PR #428 evidence below. Historical cf9bb9d results retain their pin	Active; approved effective hash required. Auto additionally binds its composition
D6 accounting: no product dollar stop, unknown cost stays unknown (§14.5)	Implemented at cf9bb9d, merged via PR #276	Offline-verified; former strict xfails now pass	Active
Luna admission in the shipped Auto composition (§14.7)	Implemented as configuration at `bf440cb`; `openai/fast`, `conservative-utf8`, explicit empirical limitations	Code inspection; overlay tests; one reported live easy slice at `df7dc3c`	Available in approved opt-in Auto launches; not added to shipped ordinary roles
Historical Plan 12.2 qualification, summary-quality and real-editor obligations (§14.6)	Retain their named contracts and composition identities	The 2026-10-08 deferred disposition is historical; consult the Plan 12.2 amendment and #237 for its evidence. Auto does not establish universal Luna estimator qualification	Separate from Luna's Auto admission; no historical receipt is promoted to this pin
Auto classification and per-turn routing (§6, §10.D, §14.7)	Implemented at `bf440cb`; H accepted by ADR-028, which accepts ADR-007	Unit tests, reported PR #428 suites/CI and three live acpx slices at `df7dc3c`; see Auto evidence below	Opt-in: `OPTIMUS_AGENT_MODEL=auto`, under an approved Auto composition
Automatic struggle escalation (ADR-009 rung 2, §14.8)	Implemented at `5977155` as scoped by ADR-029; one move per interactive Auto turn to the escalation role's first routable model	Unit and unit composition tests; reported suites, scripted acpx/Zed escalation and separate real-model Zed cases below. A real model stuck enough to escalate remains owed in #397	Available in interactive Auto planning under its approved composition; fixed-model/headless callers unchanged
Host/Gateway timing (§14.9)	Shared 60 s attempt timeout, 120 s upstream-dispatch budget, 135 s default host wait; worker deadlines and 32-slot cap at `5977155`	Real-socket/unit regressions, reported revert checks and Z3's 51 s known-cost reply; see evidence below	Production defaults; responsive Gateway processing/storage required. No whole-request Gateway-processing deadline or prompt in-flight cancellation claim
Final reviewer step (ADR-008) and net savings report (ADR-012)	Reviewer step proposed (ADR-008, status Proposed); savings report specified (ADR-012 accepted with open items, issue #248); neither implemented	None	Deferred under existing owners
Product coverage gate (§12)	Implemented (`tools/check_product_coverage.py`, `tools/product-coverage-groups.json`)	CI-enforced (`guardrails.yml`); measured at cf9bb9d	Active in CI
DeepEval, Ragas and PyRIT evaluations (§12)	Not established by inspection: no dependency, import or test	UNRUN	Inactive

Capability	Implementation	Verification	Activation
Phase 2 Rust supervisor and Phase 3 mesh (§10.C)	Proposed (Roadmap v11); no Rust source in the repository	None	None

#397 escalation and timing evidence. Source inspection for these additions is at main `5977155c2bce9728156ee5898ff9e17d0ae08750`, PR #437's merge on 2026-10-29. The repository-visible record is `docs/sources/p397-escalation/validation-record.md`; ADR-029 records the accepted decision and remaining real-model criterion. The record's earlier CI entry remains a dated pre-merge obligation, not a claim that the later CI was unrun.

The record reports Windows full suites with coverage at `a358d58`, then `ca66625` (10,417 passed, 52 skipped, 106 deselected, 0 failed), then `07e7ed2` (10,462 passed, 52 skipped, 106 deselected, 2 failed). The two last-run failures were inventory checks, fixed in `6ca4bee`; retry-report fixes `bfee317` and `5630fe9` also followed that full suite. Those deltas had focused checks only, including 852 passed and 22 deselected for the last retry-report fix; no later Windows full suite is inferred. The record preserves the first timing revert check's surviving late-handshake gap and the added check that caught it, all five #432 revert parts, and the later five-part retry-report check.

PR #437 guardrails run 40903870999 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40903870999), job `clean-environment-recheck`, passed on Linux/Python 3.14.10 at test merge ref `a53b6888708dcfb7c36ac27349ac187f66fdadb0`, combining PR head `0d68dfebee35ad61fcc8f87c61838185131e8e34` with main `2b183c8baeb881c26121341f5825e7c212a6e5fa`: 10,208 passed, 309 skipped, 106 deselected, 1 warning, 0 failed. Required product floors and full-run coverage validity passed. Run `20261029T154119-3004-c688fb` reported active default selection, COMPLETE records and unsupported Linux native/parent/guard capability; this is not Windows parity. Main-push guardrails run 40909335091 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40909335091) subsequently completed successfully on Linux/Python 3.14.10 at actual merge `5977155c2bce9728156ee5898ff9e17d0ae08750`: 10,208 passed, 309 skipped, 106 deselected, 1 warning, 0 failed. Required coverage floors passed: Optimus 89.7079%, Context Engine 95.9243% and model policy 94.4251%; full-run coverage validity passed. Its run `20261029T161355-2787-7329e8` recorded active default selection, clean source before/after, COMPLETE records and unsupported Linux native/parent/guard capability. Work status page run 40909335032 at the same merge also succeeded. These are separate main-push results, not a relabelling of PR CI or Windows evidence.

Scripted live evidence at `ca66625` used the plan r6 S1 exception, not a real model struggling: independent acpx A1′ escalated once and stopped at the check-in; real Zed U2 stopped, U5 cancelled at the check-in, U4 had no stronger target, and U3 continued before separate plan approval. The record preserves the stub lifetime expiry and second attempt for the remaining Zed chain. Unit sources exercise triggers, graph eligibility, target limits, halt/notice handling, one move, receipts, the meter and approved application. The configured-server test in `tests/unit/acp/test_auto_escalation_end_to_end.py` replaces network/provider dependencies and remains unit composition evidence, despite its file name.

Real-model Zed evidence is separate: U1/Z1 at `3272ce0` completed; Z2 at that head routed up for low confidence but lost a billed reply to the former 30-second host timeout and stopped with unknown cost. Z2 was not rerun. Z3 at `07e7ed2` received a 51-second reply with known cost, then the model refused the task. Known paid spend is reported as USD 0.0587, including Z2's lost reply. These cases do not satisfy the real-model struggle-to-escalation criterion (plan r6 S3), still owed in #397. Prompt cancellation during an in-flight Gateway call and an end-to-end Gateway-processing deadline also remain owed there. The documentation follow-up closes only after the separately authorized successor PR merges; this text does not declare #397 closed.

Original Auto evidence. Source inspection for the original registry/construction/Auto statements is at main `bf440cba5c184f8bca7ed8af0a0ae6bb824f14f1`. Named tests cover launch binding, per-turn routing, shared model stops, H, decisions, notices and records. `tests/unit/acp/test_auto_launch_end_to_end.py` drives the real configured server over NDJSON through the adapter and AgentRunner, with external dependencies replaced; it is unit composition evidence, not independent live ACP acceptance.

PR #428 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/pull/428) reports the Windows full suite with coverage at `3420eb2`: 10,107 passed, 50 skipped, 101 deselected, 1 warning; required product coverage gates passed. That run predates the Linux test-isolation correction and merge of main. The PR also preserves the first Linux run's three test failures and the correction at `236a3c4`, plus two repository-layout failures while the merge index remained unmerged. These are not silently converted into final-head passes. At final PR head `df7dc3c52dbc64ec5d18d27e05766c1953715853`, guardrails run

40469959706 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40469959706) completed successfully. No workflow runs were returned for merge commit `bf440cb` during this authoring pass; no merge-commit CI pass or Windows rerun is inferred.

#395 comment 6437429914 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/issues/395#issuecomment-6437429914) reports acpx 0.12.0 Agent-mode live slices at `df7dc3c`: easy to Luna, medium to Gemini, complex through Jev to Gemini; 3/3 passed, reported total USD 0.005858. The report identifies routing records, first-message notices, completed accounting, file outcomes and process cleanup. Haiku, easy's second model, was not exercised. Jev's dated resolved-model snapshot displayed as `unrecognized` in the Gateway log; the report distinguishes this diagnostic limitation from the accepted decision reply. These are reported PR-head results, not fresh runs or independent inspection of the external raw bundle. Its archival seal is identified in that repository-visible comment; the external folder is not an operating dependency.

The filed pilot evidence (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/tree/bf440cba5c184f8bca7ed8af0a0ae6bb824f14f1/docs/sources/plan-12-4-auto-pilot) and ADR-028 record H's selection and limitations. Pilot acceptance is not a guarantee of population accuracy, task success or savings. Round 2 and the successor filing retain custody under #395; this evidence does not close the whole plan.

EDIT evidence. Unit and runner tests (`tests/unit/agent/test_edit_directives.py`, `test_edits.py`, `test_runner_edit.py`, through the real `AgentRunner`). PR #411 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/pull/411): Windows full suite failed at `271c16a` with 4 probe import-closure failures; final run at `92df22f`: 9,430 passed, 49 skipped, 101 deselected, 1 warning. guardrails run 40069592519 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40069592519): pull_request, head `92df22f`, success. #407 comment 6382141300 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/issues/407#issuecomment-6382141300): live acpx 0.12.0, Haiku 5.5, 2026-10-24, exact-byte edit of a 110,167-byte file, USD 0.0014817. Failure paths have unit/runner evidence only, not live evidence. These are PR-head results, not merge-commit reruns.

PR #413 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/pull/413), head `a970189`, merged as `159a712`: its reported Windows full suite with coverage gave 9,610 passed, 49 skipped, 101 deselected, 1 warning. guardrails run 40093667921 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40093667921): pull_request, head `a970189`, success. Codex CLI round 55 accepted that head for its full-suite gate; rounds 48–55, including the earlier NOT ACCEPTED reviews, remain on #410 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/issues/410#issuecomment-6384154573).

PR #414 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/pull/414), head `87b7b06`, merged as `57e2069`: its reported Windows full suite with coverage gave 9,431 passed, 49 skipped, 101 deselected, 1 warning; its Codex CLI checkpoint review reported APPROVE. guardrails run 40093673312 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40093673312): pull_request, head `87b7b06`, success. The first Masterplan impact run 40093673253 failed for a missing declaration (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40093673253); replacement run 40094074645 succeeded at the same head (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40094074645).

Post-merge main `57e2069`: guardrails run 40096867014 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40096867014) and Work status page run 40096866988 (https://github.com/vibhanshu-agarwal/optimus-cost-agent/actions/runs/40096866988), both push events at that merge head, succeeded. These CI results are separate from the Windows PR-head suites. Neither PR #413 nor PR #414 adds live evidence; the only live run above remains at `92df22f`.

Evidence anchors. `cf9bb9d73ac6c8c3be508966245e0db7cdaaa503` is the historical offline implementation candidate reviewed by Codex on 2026-10-04; `5ee081e` filed the documentation; `2068366` is the boundary through which the operator accepted the offline implementation and documentation on 2026-10-08; PR #276 merged that work as `c509fc8` on 2026-10-08. The acceptance scope and deferred obligations are in `docs/superpowers/reviews/2026-10-04-plan-12-2-cp4-offline-review-disposition.md` and `2026-10-08-plan-12-2-cp4-offline-delivery-disposition.md`; source custody is in `docs/sources/plan-12-2-context-engine-closure/README.md`. Historical passes are not transferred to `91fd64a`. At the filing state this correction's documentation checks passed; the coverage-free commit-profile hook (`run_profile --profile commit`) selected a broad fallback of 6697 tests and failed on this host's unprovisioned ast-grep hook environment (6659 passed, 37 skipped, 1 warning, 1 error, exit 1), and it emitted the platform obligation `wsl-platform:`

`next checkpoint`, which is undischarged. The exact results are in the validation record filed with the sources. No new full-suite, coverage, live-qualification or activation result is claimed, and no product suite, live run or activation was commissioned.